Throwbacks and pullbacks. As I'm writing this book, I get a sense of the numbers for pattern behavior. I know that throwbacks and pullbacks happen about two-thirds of the time. Scallops deviate from that somewhat as the table shows.

It usually takes 11 or 12 days to make a round-trip during a throwback or pullback (to return to the breakout price), and half that time to reach the apex of its turn on average. Downward breakouts in bear markets make an aggressive push downward, falling 12% in 6 days (which is very unusual because it's so large). That's based on 274 patterns, so the sample count is high (good), too.

If a throwback or pullback appears, performance usually suffers. However, downward breakouts in bull markets don't see any performance difference.

After a throwback or pullback completes, price resumes moving in the breakout direction most of the time, with the exception being downward breakouts in bear markets. Those see price rise 55% of the time (only 45% continue lower).

Gaps. Scallops show mixed results as far as breakout day gaps are concerned. They lean toward gaps helping performance (two out of three columns support this).

If you want to participate in better gap performance, then you're in luck. I measured performance using the opening price the day *after* the gap (to the ultimate high or low), so you can buy in and enjoy the ride, hopefully, to larger profit, even though you missed owning the stock during the gap.

Table 60.5 shows pattern size statistics.

Height. Tall scallops perform better than short ones across all three columns. Height is one of the most reliable predictors of future performance. To use this finding, measure the scallop's height and divide it by the breakout price. Then compare the result against the median listed in the table. Values above the median are tall patterns.